



Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations

D2.TTG.CL3.15

Assessor Manual



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Project Base

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: PLAN, TRIAL AND IMPLEMENT MINIMAL IMPACT OPERATIONS		NOMINAL HOURS: 80
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTG.CL3.15		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to plan and conduct tourism activities that will have a minimal negative impact on the environment and the society in which it is conducted so as to optimise the concept of sustainable tourism		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Plan minimal impact operations 1.1 Identify the <i>proposed activity/operation</i> to be conducted 1.2 Identify the <i>location</i> in which the identified activity/operation is proposed to be conducted 1.3 Research the <i>factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity</i> 1.4 Research the <i>compliance requirements</i> that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location 1.5 Develop a <i>plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented</i> Element 2: Trial minimal impact operations 2.1 <i>Organise for the trial</i> to be conducted 2.2 Conduct the trial operation as planned		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to all industry sectors within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: Travel Agencies Tour Operation <i>Proposed activity/operation</i> may be related to: - Constructing facilities - Introducing tours - Introducing interpretive activities - Establishing camps - Interaction with wildlife.

2.3 <i>Monitor the impacts of the trial</i> 2.4 <i>Evaluate the information generated by the trial</i> 2.5 <i>Utilise the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts</i> Element 3: Implement minimal impact operations 3.1 <i>Apply revised plans to the practical application of minimal impact tourism activities/operations</i> 3.2 <i>Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions</i> 3.3 <i>Implement ongoing monitoring protocols</i> Element 4: Evaluate minimal impact operations 4.1 <i>Collect objective environmental data</i> 4.2 <i>Solicit feedback from the local community and staff</i> 4.3 <i>Collaborate with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation</i> 4.4 <i>Modify previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained</i>	<i>Location</i> refers to: • The immediate geographic vicinity in which the activity/operation is proposed • Other geographic locations that may be impacted by the activity/operation, including consideration of routes that will enable access. <i>Factors that</i> may be impacted by the proposed activity can be either positive or negative and may include: • Environmental, including the natural and built environment • Social, including social dislocation and changes to existing social interactions within the local community • Ecological, addressing the impact on animals and their habitat, plants and other organisms • Economic, including employment, investment, inflation, impact on local income, effects of partial reliance on tourism-related income and contribution to regional development • Cultural, including art, dance, music, storytelling, tools, implements, foods, artefacts, symbols, symbolic actions, rituals, rites, ceremonies, celebrations, heroes, significant figures, individuals, beliefs, assumptions, values, attitudes, language, religion, education, social institutions and cultural sites. <i>Compliance requirements</i> relate to: • Local rules, regulations and by-laws • National legislation of the host country • Codes of practice • Requirements imposed by existing businesses and operations.
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	<i>Plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented</i> should address: • How the proposal meets identified local needs and addresses identified concerns, including action to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts • Extent and type of activities and operations proposed, including specification of the site/location to be used and the nature of the activities/operations to be conducted • Timing details, including development time, commencement dates, duration of the activity/operation and specification of daily hours of operation • Evidence of gaining appropriate approvals, permissions, authorities, licenses and registrations from local communities and authorities • Behaviour stipulations for tour group members who visit • Details of the trial process that will be followed prior to full implementation of the proposal • Explanation of how objectors can register their objection to the proposal and explanation of the process that will be followed when an objection is received • Consultation that will occur with relevant communities and individuals prior to the final implementation decision being made • Monitoring protocols that will be used to assess the impact of the proposal on the local environment and communities. <i>Organise for the trial</i> may include: • Notifying key stakeholders and gaining their approval and cooperation • Establishing the infrastructure to support the initiative • Putting identified monitoring equipment and systems in place • Detailing the parameters of the trial and the criteria by which it will be evaluated • Committing to transparency in the implementation of the trial and the release of the data gathered during the monitoring process • Establishing initial benchmarks against which comparisons will be made following the trial.
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	<i>Monitor the impacts</i> may include the use of: • Completing logbooks • Filling in sighting forms • Making personal observations • Taking basic measurements, including temperature, weather conditions, estimations of percentage cover, water flow, water volumes and customer traffic counts • Photography • Gathering anecdotal evidence • Liaising with key stakeholders. <i>Evaluate the information</i> should include consideration, quantification and analysis of positive and negative impacts which can include: • Environmental – positive: ▪ Opportunities for conservation and protection of buildings and facilities ▪ Opportunities for conservation and protection of the natural environment ▪ Education of visitors relating to local environmental issues ▪ Potential to improve sites that have been de-graded prior to the initiative • Environmental – negative: ▪ Physical damage to building, facilities and the natural environment, including erosion ▪ Pollution ▪ Waste, energy and consumable demands on the local area ▪ Adverse visual impacts • Social – positive: ▪ Improved facilities and infrastructure ▪ Improved understanding regarding local issues ▪ Improved relationships between the local community and other communities
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	▪ More things to do and increased opportunities to interact with others • Social – negative: ▪ Social dislocation ▪ Potential for increase in criminal activities ▪ Reduced focus on and potential interruptions to traditional social interactions and activities • Ecological – positive: ▪ Increased awareness of ecological issues ▪ Potential for investment to create additional habitat to encourage the growth and development in numbers and species of flora and fauna • Ecological – negative: ▪ Disturbance to flora and fauna ▪ Introduction of feral/exotic species • Economic – positive: ▪ Increased employment opportunities for local population ▪ Increased investment ▪ Increased local revenue, foreign exchange earnings and spending potential • Economic – negative: ▪ Potential for unacceptable levels of inflation ▪ Obligations that can result from reliance on tourism income • Cultural – positive: ▪ Sharing of culture with the wider community ▪ Better understanding of culture amongst other communities
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	• Cultural – negative: ▪ Trivialisation of the culture ▪ Potential for established culture to be altered against the will of and despite the activities of the local community. <i>Modify previous plans</i> may include: • Cancelling the proposed activity/operation • Revising aspects of the plan that were highlighted as negative, including the types and nature of activities, the physical location and size of the proposal, timing considerations and amount of investment • Expanding plans for those aspects of the plan that received a positive trial result • Gaining necessary approvals and authorisations from key stakeholders for the revised plans • Organising, conducting, monitoring and evaluating a supplementary trial, where required and appropriate. <i>Apply revised plans</i> should include: • Implementing the plans as proposed • Using minimal impact techniques and procedures, including education on appropriate behavioural patterns, site hardening, technological solutions, restricting or limiting access and staged authenticity, as appropriate • Liaising with key stakeholders to ensure ongoing support and positive relationships. <i>Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions</i> may include: • Acting as a role model • Sharing lessons learned with others seeking to apply minimal impact operations • Promoting the benefits that have flowed from running a minimal impact operation.
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Collect objective environmental data will include:

- Implementing the planned data gathering procedures
- Analysing and evaluating the collected data
- Sharing the data and analysis with key stakeholders
- Demonstrating transparency in data collection and analysis.

Solicit feedback may include:

- Verbal and written feedback
- Maintaining a feedback database/file
- Proactively seeking feedback
- Conducting consultation and feedback meetings
- Sharing the feedback with key stakeholders
- Thanking contributors who provide feedback
- Requiring staff to provide feedback.

Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- The enterprise's policies and procedures in regard to planning, trialling and implementing minimal impact operations
- Knowledge of legislation, regulations, codes of practice and requirements of the host country where the tourism operation is proposed
- Principles of communication and negotiation with communities and authorities
- Knowledge of global environmental issues and measures to address them
- Ability to use techniques and technologies that will minimise the impact of tourism activity/operation

	• Ability to capture data on the impact of tourism operations • Ability to use planning, negotiation, organisational monitoring and management skills. Linkages To Other Units • Develop and update tourism industry knowledge • Coordinate and operate a day-tour or short excursions • Manage and facilitate an extended tour experience • Plan, develop and evaluate interpretive activities • Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities • Conduct interpretive activities in the field • Develop and coordinate appropriate cultural tourism activity • Research and share information on indigenous cultures • Develop and implement operational plans • Manage operational risk • Monitor tourism operations • Assess and plan tourism opportunities for local communities • Develop and monitor culturally appropriate tourism activity • Develop/monitor ecologically sustainable tourism operations. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of host enterprise policies and procedures in regard to planning, trialling and implementing minimal impact operations • Demonstrated ability to research, develop and present a viable written plan to support the trial of a small-scale minimal impact activity/operation, chosen by the candidate, in a nominated location
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- Demonstrated ability to put into practice a nominated prepared plan to trial the implementation of a small-scale minimal impact activity/operation, and record and evaluate the results of the trial in such a way that they can be used to prepare a revised plan
- Demonstrated ability to prepare a revised plan to enable the implementation of a nominated small-scale minimal impact activity/operation in a nominated location that reflects the information gained as a result of a trial of the activity/operation
- Demonstrated ability to collect relevant data and feedback in relation to the implementation of a nominated small-scale minimal impact activity/operation and demonstrate how this information may be used to modify the original plan on which the activity/operation was based.

Context of Assessment

Assessment must ensure:

- Actual or simulated office environment for the planning phase and an actual location and activity/operation for the demonstration of practical trialling, implementation and evaluation skills.

Resource Implications

Training and assessment must include the use of a real location, real communities and stakeholders and a real or simulated activity/operation; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Note: all practical assessment requirements may relate to the one location and the same activity/operation and the assessments may flow from each other.

Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Portfolio of documentation, including plans, permissions and feedback sheets
- Feedback from local communities
- Role plays

	• Oral and written questions • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work. Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Research initial information for the preparation of plans; monitor data, evaluate and draw conclusions
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Explain the potential impact of the proposed activity/operation to key stakeholders
	Planning and organising activities	2	Develop and revise plans
	Working with others and in teams	2	Liaise with local communities and key stakeholders
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculate data gathered from monitoring equipment; calculating costs
	Solving problems	2	Address negative impacts to achieve a positive result
	Using technology	1	Use the internet to research material; use monitoring equipment to capture data

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations D2.TTG.CL3.15
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. What are the factors you would consider when identifying activities/operations which need to be planned from a minimal impact perspective?	☐	☐
2. Give me three examples of locations where minimal impact tourism/tour operations might be conducted.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Describe how to research factors that might be impacted by a proposed tourism activity.	☐	☐
4. Give me three examples of compliance requirements which apply to implementing a tour activity in a sensitive location.	☐	☐
5. Tell me about the contents of a plan which underpins the implementation of a proposed tourism activity in a sensitive location.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What is involved in organising a trial for a proposed tourism activity in a sensitive location?	☐	☐
7. Explain implementation of a trial tourism activity you have been involved with in a sensitive area: what was planned? Who was involved? What was done?	☐	☐
8. For the trial used as the basis for your previous answer, how was the trial monitored?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. With reference to the last question, how was the trial evaluated and what were the findings?	☐	☐
10. Give me an example of how lessons learned from the trial we have talked about were used to modify plans for future implementation of the activity.	☐	☐
11. Describe implementation of a revised plan for a tourism activity in a sensitive area for which trials were conducted: how were preparations undertaken? What precautions were taken?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. For the activity used as the focus for the previous question, describe the actual conduct of the tour activity: how did it go? Who was involved? What happened?	☐	☐
13. How did you monitor the implementation of the tour activity used in the answer to the previous question? Who did the monitoring? When did it occur? Who was involved?	☐	☐
14. Identify a minimal impact tourism activity you have implemented and describe the data which was collected to form the basis of formal evaluation.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. In relation to your answer to the previous question, what was done to solicit feedback from the local community and tour staff?	☐	☐
16. Give me an example of how, when and where you have actively collaborated with local authorities to responsibly manage tour operations in a sensitive area.	☐	☐
17. Give me an example of how, when and where you have modified tour plans to protect a sensitive area on the basis of the evaluation of previous tours to the location.	☐	☐

Written questions

Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations – D2.TTG.CL3.15

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. In your own words describe minimal impact tourism.

2. Give three examples of possible minimal impact tourism activities/operations which may be addressed in a sustainable or minimal impact manner.

3. Explain what is required when identifying the location of a tourism activity or operation.

4. List three reasons the exact location/s for proposed tourism initiatives need to be correctly and specifically determined.

5. Name three techniques proposers of minimal impact tourism initiatives might use to define the location of a proposed activity/operation.

6. Identify three points which provide a context for researching the factors which might be impacted by minimal impact tourism initiatives.

7. Name three natural environment factors which may be researched when addressing environmental concerns relating to a proposed minimal impact tourism initiative.

8. Name two ecological factors to take into account when researching environmental factors relating to a proposed minimal impact tourism initiative.
- _____
- _____
9. Identify five possible negative impacts of a tourism initiative on the society/culture of an area or local community.
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
10. List three possible economic factors which might be impacted by the introduction of a minimal impact tourism activity.
- _____
- _____
- _____
11. List three ways to undertake research on factors likely to be impacted by a tourism initiative.
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
12. Name three possible sources of information on compliance requirements which might apply to a proposed tourism activity/operation and area.
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

13. What are the three basic pre-requisites given in the notes for a plan for the trial of a minimal impact tourism initiative?

14. Identify five standard requirements/inclusions in plans for the trial of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

15. Select one of the six ASEAN Tourism Standards and describe three of the requirements for that Standard.

16. Describe three ways the details of plans for a trial/pilot of a minimal impact tourism activity may be confirmed with stakeholders.

17. As part of the organisation for a tourism initiative, infrastructure needs to be provided/organised; briefly discuss this requirement.

18. Most trials of tourism initiatives will set criteria by which the trial will be evaluated: identify and discuss the two main requirements in this regard.

19. List three important considerations relating to the establishment of benchmarks at the start of a minimal impact tourism initiative trial/pilot.

20. List five considerations when implementing the trial for a proposed sustainable tourism activity or operation.

21. Give three standard industry protocols when implementing monitoring activities for a minimal impact tourism trial.

22. Identify three data gathering options/possibilities for the purposes of monitoring the impacts of a sustainable tourism project.

23. Name five important 'points to note' when evaluating the information generated by a minimal impact tourism trial.

24. List three possible positive environmental impacts of a tourism trial.

25. List three possible negative environmental impacts of a tourism trial.

26. List three possible positive social impacts of a tourism trial.

27. List two possible positive cultural impacts of a tourism trial.

28. List two possible negative cultural impacts of a tourism trial.

29. Describe three important points to note following the evaluation of a minimal impact tourism trial.

30. Describe two situations where the evaluation of a trial will indicate the proposal should be abandoned or cancelled.

31. List three ways the impact of a trial minimal impact tourism activity may be constrained.

32. Provide three essential requirements when applying revised plans for a sustainable tourism initiative.

33. Give three reasons there is a need for Tourist Operators to conduct sustainable tourism initiatives in a way that encourages others to do the same.

34. Identify three strategies which can be used to encourage engagement of other Tourism Operators in sustainable tourism initiatives.

35. List three keys in implementing agreed monitoring protocols as part of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

36. What is identified in the notes as the 'Core requirement' in relation to collecting objective environmental data?

37. List five of the activities/steps which should followed to vary the planned data gathering procedures for a minimal impact tourism initiative.

38. Describe three ways objective data may be obtained when monitoring the implementation of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

39. Identify five examples of technical equipment/technology which may be used to capture objective data when monitoring a minimal impact tourism initiative.

40. List three considerations or activities when collecting objective environmental data about the implementation of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

41. List five keys to be applied when soliciting feedback about the implementation of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

42. Identify three points which help provide a context when collaborating with others to minimise adverse impacts of a sustainable tourism initiative.

43. What are the four basic options available when seeking to minimise the adverse impacts of a minimal impact tourism initiative?

44. List five activities inherent in participating in the collaboration process to manage the impacts of a tourism initiative on local issues.

45. List five points which illustrate the context when modifying plans for a minimal impact initiative on the basis of valid monitoring data obtained from implementation.

46. Identify one classification of changes which may need to be made to a minimal impact tourism initiative and list three actions which could be taken to achieve the required change.

Answers to written questions

Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations – D2.TTG.CL3.15

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. In your own words describe minimal impact tourism.

Answer should address:

- Reference to terms such as :
 - Green tourism; Responsible tourism; Eco-tourism; Environmental tourism; Ethical tourism
- Critical in the notion are Tourism Operators taking action to:
 - Avoid damage to the area visited
 - Minimise impact on the area visited
 - Repair previous damage.

2. Give three examples of possible minimal impact tourism activities/operations which may be addressed in a sustainable or minimal impact manner.

- Constructing facilities – such as:
 - Access roads; Buildings; Infrastructure
- Introducing tours – into areas where there was previously no tours
- Increasing the tourist footprint – in terms of, for example:
 - Bringing in more visitors; Increasing the number of tours to the area; Increasing the duration of tours
- introducing interpretive activities – which may require:
 - Access to new/different areas; Use of local resources; Involvement of local communities
- Establishing camps – for over-night and/or longer stays where there will be a demand for:
 - Toilet and washing facilities; Cooking and eating facilities
- Interacting with wildlife – as:
 - Part of a tour; Caused by tourist intrusion (camps; travel through regions) into their natural habitat.

3. Explain what is required when identifying the location of a tourism activity or operation.

Answer should address:

- Describing the immediate geographic vicinity in which the activity/operation itself is proposed – which may occur with reference to:
 - Specific latitudinal and longitudinal points
 - Name of country/countries
 - Local (recognised or generally accepted and understood) names –for towns, villages, communities, areas, regions, locales and/or points of interest
 - Geographic features – such as mountains, rivers, lakes, coastlines, islands and other prominent landforms
- Stating associated geographic locations that may be impacted by the activity/operation – which may require specification of:
 - Camp sites not intrinsic to the proposed tour activity
 - Position of supporting facilities – such as parking and loading/unloading areas, airfields/landing areas, storage space for permanent plant and equipment, infrastructure,
 - Routes that will enable access (ingress and egress) to the activity/operation – including details of land, water and air travel.

4. List three reasons the exact location/s for proposed tourism initiatives need to be correctly and specifically determined.

- Demonstrate transparency and openness in the proposal
- Ensure all those potentially impacted can be made aware of the proposal
- Make sure the correct/necessary people (communities, locals, government agencies) are involved
- Begin the process of researching government funding which may be available for the area
- Research standard factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity
- Identify the country/countries involved
- Start the process of identifying other Tourism Operators who may be operating in the area
- Enable identification of other non-legislated requirements which apply
- Provide a real-world context for the written plan which will be prepared.

5. Name three techniques proposers of minimal impact tourism initiatives might use to define the location of a proposed activity/operation.

- Visit the site/area – ensuring:
 - Notes are taken to describe required and/or preferred locations
 - GPS technology is used to record points
- Talk to locals – to:
 - Identify local names
 - Initiate contact and relationship building
 - Find out other tours/activities already being conducted
- Speak to industry bodies – to:
 - Obtain applicable Codes
 - Obtain relevant reports and/or research on the area
- Liaise with government agencies – to:
 - Obtain information they have on the proposal/site
 - Determine their orientation to the proposed activity
 - Obtain copies of applicable legislation
- Use of suitably detailed maps – commonly a combination of:
 - General reference maps
 - Topographic maps.

6. Identify three points which provide a context for researching the factors which might be impacted by minimal impact tourism initiatives.

- It is one of the fundamental tenets underpinning acceptance of minimal impact tourism that all tourism activity has some impact – no initiative in this regard is ever totally free of impact
- The number and extent of the impact can and will vary between initiatives
- Previous, like initiatives can provide an indication of another similar initiatives – but the link is not necessarily a direct one
- Impacts can be positive or negative – a positive impact in one area/set of factors can also result in a negative impact in one or more other areas/sets of factors: the impact is not always unilaterally positive or negative for any given initiative
- There is often a lack of clarity and/or consensus about what the projected impacts of a minimal impact tourism initiative will be
- Tourism Operators who subscribe to an industry Code relating to sustainable/ minimal impact tourism development/operation are commonly required by that Code to research impact on these factors
- There is often a mandatory external requirement for research of this type to be undertaken – before a proposal can be approved by local communities, government agencies or industry bodies (and/or for funding).

7. Name three natural environment factors which may be researched when addressing environmental concerns relating to a proposed minimal impact tourism initiative.

- Possible air pollution – caused by vehicles and camp fires
- Contamination of fresh, sea and drinking water through litter and sewage
- Degradation of the land and the landscape – as a result of vehicles, physical presence of tourists, tourism activities on-site, camping
- Increased use of scarce local resources – such as fuel, drinking water,
- Greater levels of noise – caused by the extra vehicles, activities and people
- Aesthetic pollution – caused by presence of vehicles, people and man-made items in a pristine, natural environment
- Increase in litter and rubbish.

8. Name two ecological factors to take into account when researching environmental factors relating to a proposed minimal impact tourism initiative.

- Animals and their habitat
- Plants
- Other organisms.

9. Identify five possible negative impacts of a tourism initiative on the society/culture of an area or local community.

- Commodification of a community/society
- Standardisation
- Loss of authenticity
- Adaptation to tourist demands
- Cultural clashes
- Increase in crime rates
- Child labour
- Prostitution and sex tourism.

10. List three possible economic factors which might be impacted by the introduction of a minimal impact tourism activity.

- Employment
- Investment
- Inflation
- Local income
- Opportunity cost

- The extent of the reliance on tourism-related income and the contribution made by tourism to regional development.

11. List three ways to undertake research on factors likely to be impacted by a tourism initiative.

- Talk to those who have conducted similar operations in similar areas – to obtain their input
- Read reports on previous similar activities – many of these exist to provide data on other tourism initiatives.
- Speak with local communities who have been the subject of previous activities
- Communicate with those expected to be impacted by the proposed activity
- Establish baseline data/benchmarks – to use as reference points for future monitoring and evaluation
- Visit the area – to gain first-hand experience of the location and meet face-to-face with the community and those who will/may be impacted.

12. Name three possible sources of information on compliance requirements which might apply to a proposed tourism activity/operation and area.

- Legislation
- By-laws
- Voluntary Codes of Practice
- Mandatory Codes of Practice
- Agreements which are already in place with local communities
- Arrangements already agreed to by the Tourism Operator.

13. What are the three basic pre-requisites given in the notes for a plan for the trial of a minimal impact tourism initiative?

The plan must be:

- In writing
- The result of adequate consideration and consultation
- Be realistic and achievable.

14. Identify five standard requirements/inclusions in plans for the trial of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

- Explanation of how the proposal meets identified local needs – while at the same time addressing identified concerns by including action to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts
- Description of the extent and type of activities and operations proposed – including specification of the site/location to be used and the nature of the activities/operations to be conducted
- Identification of timing details – including development time, commencement dates, duration of the activity/operation and specification of daily hours of operation
- Provision of evidence proving required approvals, permissions, authorities, licenses and registrations have been approved/granted – by local communities and authorities
- Development of behaviour stipulations for tour group members – when they visit the site, participate in activities and/or engage with local people and communities
- Identification of the process that will be followed for trialling the initiative – prior to full implementation of the proposal
- Explanation of how objectors can register their objection to the proposal – together with explanation of the process that will be followed when an objection is received
- Consultation that will occur with relevant communities and individuals – prior to the final implementation decision being made
- Description of the monitoring protocols that will be used – to assess the impact of the proposal on the local environment and communities.

15. Select one of the six ASEAN Tourism Standards and describe three of the requirements for that Standard.

No model answer.

16. Describe three ways the details of plans for a trial/pilot of a minimal impact tourism activity may be confirmed with stakeholders.

Confirming the plans/details for the trial/pilot of an activity may:

- Require presentation and explanation of final trial plans – in a face-to-face meeting with stakeholders/local communities
- Involve explanation of details
- Necessitate responses to questions and concerns
- Confirm checks and monitoring activities which have been provided as an integral element of the trial
- Demand readiness to make last-minute changes which may be required by key stakeholders – or to address valid issues which have been overlooked
- Result in re-formulating draft trial plans.

17. As part of the organisation for a tourism initiative, infrastructure needs to be provided/organised; briefly discuss this requirement.

Answer should address;

- This is not required for all initiatives as it may already exist
- Tourism Operators are reluctant to pay significant sums of money for trials – because there is no guarantee the trial will translate into an ongoing activity/operation
- Where there is support from government agencies there is a likelihood they will contribute some ‘seeding’ funding to initiate the project and demonstrate their commitment to the project
- The definition of infrastructure and what is needed can vary significantly between projects.

18. Most trials of tourism initiatives will set criteria by which the trial will be evaluated: identify and discuss the two main requirements in this regard.

- Topics of interest or concern (‘criteria’) for local communities or other stakeholders – such as (for example):
 - Quality of local water or a designated water source
 - Noise levels generated by tour groups
 - Crimes reported as a consequence of the initiative
 - Money spent in local community by tour groups
 - Satisfaction of tour group members with the experience (activity/project)
- Parameters for determining whether or not the trial was ‘acceptable’ (and could therefore go ahead) or ‘not acceptable’ (and would need to be abandoned or amended and re-trialled), such as:
 - ‘Up to 10% use of drinking water is acceptable’
 - ‘Decrease of over 5% of XYZ flora or fauna is unacceptable’
 - ‘10 complaints from the local community’
 - ‘Minimum 75% satisfaction rating from tour group members’.

19. List three important considerations relating to the establishment of benchmarks at the start of a minimal impact tourism initiative trial/pilot.

- May be decided on by one or more of the stakeholders
- Must be relevant to the individual proposal/initiative
- Should be decided on in consultation with stakeholders
- Must address identified issues and concerns
- Will form the basis of deciding the evaluation criteria and determining their parameters.

20. List five considerations when implementing the trial for a proposed sustainable tourism activity or operation.

- Conduct the trial exactly as planned
- Meet with those who have monitoring responsibilities to confirm training, resources and understanding
- Record any variations that are necessary to the planned implementation
- Take action to ensure implementation of the trial reflects future actual tourist activity after the trial
- Seek permission from stakeholders to vary the agreed plan in advance of making any changes to previously agreed protocols
- Be prepared to delay implementation if there are significant unexpected or unforeseen issues arising
- Be available.

21. Give three standard industry protocols when implementing monitoring activities for a minimal impact tourism trial.

- Train the people who are to undertake monitoring activities
- Establish one contact point for the monitoring process
- Verify required resources have been provided
- Set dates for the return of information which has been captured
- Provide easy-to-use channels to facilitate the return of information
- Oversee and manage the monitoring process
- Make public the raw data as it is obtained.

22. Identify three data gathering options/possibilities for the purposes of monitoring the impacts of a sustainable tourism project.

- Completing hand-written (or computer/lap-top/tablet-based) documents – logs, sighting forms
- Obtaining photographic evidence
- Using technology and equipment to take basic measurements relating to environmental, ecological and related concerns
- Gathering anecdotal evidence
- Liaising with key stakeholders.

23. Name five important ‘points to note’ when evaluating the information generated by a minimal impact tourism trial.

- Base decisions on facts and evidence
- Reference evaluations to the criteria and parameters established for the trial
- Consider quantitative data and qualitative information
- Align relevant data to identified topics
- Analyse positive and negative impacts
- Highlight any difficulties, problems or issues which occurred during the trial period
- Involve the stakeholders in the process to demonstrate transparency
- Generate additional data if required
- Explain the methodology used to undertake the evaluation
- Generate a set of clear and distinct findings as a result of the evaluation
- Communicate the outcomes of the trial.

24. List three possible positive environmental impacts of a tourism trial.

- Opportunities for conservation and protection of buildings and facilities
- Opportunities for conservation and protection of the natural environment
- Education of visitors relating to local environmental issues
- Potential to improve sites that have been de-graded prior to the initiative.

25. List three possible negative environmental impacts of a tourism trial.

- Physical damage to building and facilities – caused by pedestrian traffic, vehicles, use/extra use (normal ‘wear and tear’) as well as accidental and deliberate damage
- Damage to the natural environment – including soil/land erosion, compacting of soil, use of land for buildings, car parks, camp sites
- Pollution – which may involve air (smoke) pollution, water pollution, noise pollution
- Presence of waste – or additional litter/rubbish and human waste
- Use of local limited energy resources (water and wood)
- Adverse visual impacts on the site/area – as the initiative negatively affects the beauty of the area or interrupts or interferes with the ‘look and feel’ of the location.

26. List three possible positive social impacts of a tourism trial.

- Improved facilities and infrastructure – which can be used by local communities and/or which provide enhanced experiences (such as comfort and safety) for tourists
- Improved understanding regarding local issues – so there is wider awareness, and appreciation of these problems which can lead to a better understanding of the communities and may trigger external assistance for problems
- Improved relationships between the local community and other communities – based on the knowledge which flows when there is interaction between the two
- More things for local communities to do – and increased opportunities for them to interact with others and expands their horizons to become more aware of other cultures, countries and communities.

27. List two possible positive cultural impacts of a tourism trial.

- Sharing of culture with the wider community – which can bring greater recognition to communities regarding their rites, celebrations and their unique nature which serves to generate greater interest in the area and attract more tourists,
- Better understanding of culture amongst other communities

28. List two possible negative cultural impacts of a tourism trial.

- Trivialisation of the culture – and exploitation of it for commercial gain and to satisfy the interests of outsiders
- Offence (often unintended) given to locals by the comments, dress and behaviour of visitors
- Potential for established culture to be altered against the will of and despite the activities of the local community – such as the so-called ‘Westernisation’ of communities and a diminution on the importance of family.

29. Describe three important points to note following the evaluation of a minimal impact tourism trial.

- The findings of the evaluation must be used to guide future action
- Involvement of stakeholders must continue
- There can be a need to run a supplementary trial.

30. Describe two situations where the evaluation of a trial will indicate the proposal should be abandoned or cancelled.

Where the initiative:

- Will have significant/unacceptable impacts on the area and/or local community
- Does not have necessary support.

31. List three ways the impact of a trial minimal impact tourism activity may be constrained.

- Reducing the area/s visited or involved in the initiative
- Lowering numbers in tour groups
- Visiting the area on a less frequent basis
- Conducting fewer interpretive activities
- Restricting vehicle access

32. Provide three essential requirements when applying revised plans for a sustainable tourism initiative.

- Confirm the plan has been revised and approved for implementation by relevant stakeholders
- Share the revised plans
- Implement the plans as revised
- Use minimal impact techniques
- Align with the six ASEAN Tourism Standards
- Liaise with key stakeholders by communicating frequently with them.

33. Give three reasons there is a need for Tourist Operators to conduct sustainable tourism initiatives in a way that encourages others to do the same.

- Demonstrate professionalism of the organisation – to the wider community
- Show genuine commitment to ‘sustainability’ – by doing ‘a little bit extra’ than the minimum that is required
- Demonstrate transparency – in the entire implementation process by proving the organisation is prepared to let other see what they are doing
- Prove organisational interest in ‘sustainability’ is ongoing – and not just focussed on this initiative
- Attract public attention to the areas/issues of concern – and highlight how these are being effectively addressed
- Promote the ‘Six ASEAN Tourism Standards’ – and related policies
- Provide a truthful basis for making positive public statements about the organisation and its ‘sustainable’ credentials – in advertisements on website.

34. Identify three strategies which can be used to encourage engagement of other Tourism Operators in sustainable tourism initiatives.

- Acting as a role model for action
- Sharing lessons learned with industry, government agencies and other Tourism Operators
- Becoming an advocate for sustainability
- Using the media to spread the word about sustainable tourism.

35. List three keys in implementing agreed monitoring protocols as part of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

- Check necessary training has been delivered
- Verify all required resources have been supplied as promised
- Ensure the technologies used and confirmed in the pilot are used – or varied as required on the basis of the evaluation. This may require:
 - Using different technology/systems to gather data
 - Gathering data at different/more frequent times
 - Obtaining different data
- Take action to make sure the agreed ‘other’ monitoring activities are being undertaken as planned – by the people who have been designated and with the required frequency
- Follow-up with those who have responsibility for monitoring activities:
 - If no monitoring information/data is being received
 - Where there are requests for help
 - If problems arise
 - Where there is a very significant variation in the data received from what is normally obtained, or from what is expected
- Be actively and personally involved to show those involved (and others) there is real organisational engagement with the project, genuine desire to monitor the impacts and hands-on management of the project.

36. What is identified in the notes as the ‘Core requirement’ in relation to collecting objective environmental data?

- Implementing the planned data gathering procedures exactly as planned and agreed to by stakeholders.

37. List five of the activities/steps which should followed to vary the planned data gathering procedures for a minimal impact tourism initiative.

- Prompt communication with stakeholders
- Detailed description of the need for the change
- Provision of supporting data/evidence of the need for change
- Presentation of changes intended explaining why and how they will achieve the objective/s described in the ‘need for change’
- Request for approval for the identified changes to be implemented
- Allocation of responsibilities for new data gathering procedures
- Provision of necessary training and resources
- Integration of new strategies into established other monitoring activities.

- 38. Describe three ways objective data may be obtained when monitoring the implementation of a minimal impact tourism initiative.**
- Personal observation
 - Reading the meters or print-outs of technical equipment/technology
 - Conducting tests
 - Undertaking a physical examination of land or an area or other nominated site or object.
- 39. Identify five examples of technical equipment/technology which may be used to capture objective data when monitoring a minimal impact tourism initiative.**
- Hand-held water quality meters
 - Air monitors
 - Dust monitors
 - Soil samplers
 - Sound level meters
 - Vibration monitors
 - Thermometers
 - Water depth and flow gauges
 - Traffic (road count) meters
 - Turnstiles.
- 40. List three considerations or activities when collecting objective environmental data about the implementation of a minimal impact tourism initiative.**
- Try to involve stakeholders/local communities
 - Supplement data with the use of a recognised professional, external consultant
 - Verify the testing and monitoring equipment has been correctly calibrated
 - Follow-up as required with relevant people
 - Physically collect the data
 - Collate the data
 - Manipulate the data
 - Share the data and the findings.

41. List five keys to be applied when soliciting feedback about the implementation of a minimal impact tourism initiative.

- Make people aware from the outset that feedback is being sought
- Maintain a feedback database/file
- Proactively seek feedback
- Thank people for making contributions
- De-brief with staff who have been involved with the activity
- Meet on-site with other parties which may be done by integrating them into a standard tour group or holding a dedicated tour/activity just for them
- Sharing the feedback.

42. Identify three points which help provide a context when collaborating with others to minimise adverse impacts of a tourism initiative.

- The Tourism Operator has a commercial objective – that is, they want to make money and obtain a satisfactory ROI from the project.
- Impacts can be positive or negative – not all outcomes will be advantages to a community but nor will they necessarily all be bad
- Different people have different perspectives and priorities – what is important for one person/group is not necessarily what is important for another person/group.
- Issues and impacts vary over time and between different projects – based on factors which are relevant to the project and/or that apply ‘at the time’
- An organisation that is genuine in its orientation to minimal impact tourism operations must be prepared to walk away from an initiative when it is obvious the impacts of the proposal are just too severe – this is the only sensible and responsible thing that can be done.

43. What are the four basic options available when seeking to minimise the adverse impacts of a minimal impact tourism initiative?

- Abandon the project
- Do nothing
- Capitalise on any positive outcomes
- Reduce/eliminate all negative outcomes.

44. List five activities inherent in participating in the collaboration process to manage the impacts of a tourism initiative on local issues.

- Attend all meetings convened by the local authorities
- Provide requested all information/data to the local authorities
- Fund the management process
- Adhere to and honour any previous promises made about what the organisation would do if the monitoring process revealed a certain outcome
- Listen to what those who disagree have to say
- Be open and transparent when discussing issues
- Be hard but be fair
- Conduct additional research and/or monitoring – as/if required
- Record the discussions and findings – for future reference
- Share the deliberations, discussions and decisions
- Make suggestions for action.

45. List five points which illustrate the context when modifying plans for a minimal impact initiative on the basis of valid monitoring data obtained from implementation.

The changes which are made to the plans:

- Must address identified need
- Must be put in writing
- Must be integrated into the existing plan
- Must be based on actual/factual evidence
- Must be approved by those in the project management team
- Must be communicated with relevant stakeholders and with those who have responsibility allocated to them under the revised plan.

46. Identify one classification of changes which may need to be made to a minimal impact tourism initiative and list three actions which could be taken to achieve the required change.

No model answer.

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations D2.TTG.CL3.15
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Plan minimal impact operations - Trial minimal impact operations - Implement minimal impact operations - Evaluate minimal impact operations - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Plan minimal impact operations		
Identify the proposed activity/operation to be conducted	☐	☐
Identify the location in which the identified activity/operation is proposed to be conducted	☐	☐
Research the factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity	☐	☐
Research the compliance requirements that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location	☐	☐
Develop a plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented	☐	☐
Element 2: Trial minimal impact operations		
Organise for the trial to be conducted	☐	☐
Conduct the trial operation as planned	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Monitor the impacts of the trial	☐	☐
Evaluate the information generated by the trial	☐	☐
Utilise the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts	☐	☐
Element 3: Implement minimal impact operations		
Apply revised plans to the practical application of minimal impact tourism activities/operations	☐	☐
Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions	☐	☐
Implement ongoing monitoring protocols	☐	☐
Element 4: Evaluate minimal impact operations		
Collect objective environmental data	☐	☐
Solicit feedback from the local community and staff	☐	☐
Collaborate with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation	☐	☐
Modify previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations D2.TTG.CL3.15		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Identifies need to plan for tour activities and operations in sensitive locations	☐	☐	☐
Researches requirements into locations where tour activity will impact sensitive areas	☐	☐	☐
Develops plans to trial proposed activities/operations in sensitive areas	☐	☐	☐
Implements and monitors trials of proposed activities/operations in sensitive areas	☐	☐	☐
Evaluates trials of proposed activities/operations in sensitive areas and uses outcomes of same to revise further implementation plans	☐	☐	☐
Conducts tour activities/operations in sensitive areas aligning with approved plans for same and monitors their impact	☐	☐	☐
Evaluates impact of tour activities/operations in sensitive areas based on objective data collected	☐	☐	☐
Includes authorities, local communities and tour staff when evaluating minimal impact tour activities	☐	☐	☐
Revises standard tour plans to incorporate findings of evaluations into tour activities/operations in sensitive areas.	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations	D2.TTG.CL3.15
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Plan minimal impact operations						
Identify the proposed activity/operation to be conducted						
Identify the location in which the identified activity/operation is proposed to be conducted						
Research the factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity						
Research the compliance requirements that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location						
Develop a plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented						
Element 2: Trial minimal impact operations						
Organise for the trial to be conducted						
Conduct the trial operation as planned						
Monitor the impacts of the trial						
Evaluate the information generated by the trial						
Utilise the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Implement minimal impact operations						
Apply revised plans to the practical application of minimal impact tourism activities/operations						
Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions						
Implement ongoing monitoring protocols						
Element 4: Evaluate minimal impact operations						
Collect objective environmental data						
Solicit feedback from the local community and staff						
Collaborate with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation						
Modify previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

